

Charting the Competitive Edge: BI Strategy Framework for Intercity Market Dominance

A leading ride-hailing company is striving to establish itself as the market leader in the intercity car ride segment, a strategic vertical with high growth potential. Despite significant investments in marketing and being the largest spender on promotions among all competitors, the company currently holds only 20% of the total market share. This gap between promotional spending and market penetration highlights a critical need to re-evaluate existing strategies, optimize resource allocation, and identify untapped opportunities in user acquisition, retention, and product positioning to effectively scale intercity demand and achieve sustainable leadership.

The team has already implemented multiple strategies:

- Built an RFM (Recency, Frequency, Monetary)-based user segmentation strategy to engage existing users.
- Tailored communication based on users' app interaction and screen time.
- Introduced a new user promotion cycle for one month, allowing users to avail themselves of three consecutive discounts of up to 25%.
- Deployed zonal discounts targeting key business hotspots.
- Attempted cross-selling intercity rides to users of other verticals (e.g., food delivery, intracity rides).
- The product team has launched several new features to enhance the booking experience and user convenience.
- In terms of pricing, the supply side is satisfied with current pricing levels compared to competitors, and after applying discounts, user-facing fares are lower than those offered by competitors.
- Supply scales up in response to increased demand, indicating that the limitation currently lies on the demand side.

Despite these efforts, ride request volumes remain lower than expected, and market share is stagnant.

Your Role

You have been brought in as a Business Intelligence Analyst to:

1. Generate hypotheses that can be responsible for current slow growth
2. Identify bottlenecks in the user journey and current strategies.
3. Define and track key metrics that are critical for growth.
4. Uncover insights from existing data that can drive actionable decisions.
5. Recommend analytical approaches and experiments to help turn around the intercity vertical.

Business Questions to Address

1. Why is the current approach not yielding sufficient intercity ride requests despite significant promotional spending?
2. Are the current targeting methods effective?
3. What key metrics should the company monitor to better understand demand drivers and user behavior?
4. How should the effectiveness of newly launched product features be evaluated?

Your Tasks

Assume that you have access to all the required datasets. You are expected to respond to the following sections in a structured and insight-driven manner. Supporting metrics, visuals, or tables are welcome.

1. Diagnose the Problem

- What hypotheses do you have regarding the persistently low ride requests?
- How would you evaluate whether promotions are reaching the right users?
- Are there any observable issues across the user funnel?

2. Define Key Metrics

List and define the most critical metrics that you would monitor to assess performance and inform decision-making.

3. Define Analytical Methodologies

- List and explain the tests or analyses you would perform to evaluate the performance of the key metrics mentioned.
- Outline how you would evaluate the health of current strategic decisions, specifying the data points you would analyze.

4. Strategic Recommendations

Based on your overall analysis:

- What would you recommend the company stop, start, or continue doing?
- What new strategies could give the company a competitive edge in the industry?
- Are there any specific user segments, routes, or features that you would double down on?
- What could be alternative investment strategies for acquiring a more sustainable user base?
- How would you use your strategic plan to develop long-term sustainable solutions that provide a competitive advantage?

Understanding the Business: Storytelling through Data

Business Context

You have been engaged as a Data Analyst candidate for **RideFast**, a mid-sized ride-hailing platform operating across 12 cities. RideFast has approximately 35,000 registered users, 8,000 drivers, and processes over 10,000 rides per month. The company is growing but leadership has flagged several operational warning signs that are threatening profitability and user retention.

You have been given **four months of operational data** and asked to:

- Understand what is happening across key operational dimensions
- Identify the most critical business problems from the data
- Build clear, stakeholder-ready dashboards in two BI tools
- Propose data-backed solutions and present your findings

The Dataset

Your dataset consists of [four CSV files](#). You may connect them using any BI tool or pre-process them with SQL or Python before importing.

Table 1. rides.csv (120,000 rows - primary table)

This is the core fact table. Every row represents a single ride request.

Column	Type	Description
ride_id	STRING	Primary key
user_id	STRING	Foreign key → users.csv
driver_id	STRING	Foreign key → drivers.csv
city	STRING	One of 12 operating cities
pickup_zone	STRING	Sub-city zone identifier (e.g. NOR-Z04)
request_time	DATETIME	When the user requested the ride
pickup_time	DATETIME	When the driver arrived at pickup

Column	Type	Description
dropoff_time	DATETIME	Ride completion time (empty if not completed)
status	STRING	completed cancelled_driver cancelled_user no_show
fare_amount	FLOAT	Final fare in USD (0 if cancelled)
surge_multiplier	FLOAT	Surge pricing factor (1.0 = no surge)
promo_code_used	BOOLEAN	Whether a promo code was applied
promo_discount	FLOAT	Dollar amount discounted via promo
rating_by_user	FLOAT	User's rating of the ride (1–5, blank if not completed)
rating_by_driver	FLOAT	Driver's rating of user (1–5, blank if not completed)
vehicle_type	STRING	economy comfort xl
distance_km	FLOAT	Trip distance in kilometres
payment_method	STRING	card wallet cash

Table 2. drivers.csv (~8,000 rows)

Column	Type	Description
driver_id	STRING	Primary key
city	STRING	Driver's home operating city
signup_date	DATE	Date driver onboarded
vehicle_type	STRING	economy comfort xl
status	STRING	active suspended churned
avg_rating	FLOAT	Lifetime average user rating
total_rides	INTEGER	Total rides completed (lifetime)
acceptance_rate	FLOAT	% of dispatched requests accepted (0–1)
cancellation_rate	FLOAT	% of accepted rides subsequently cancelled (0–1)

Column	Type	Description
online_hours_monthly	FLOAT	Average monthly hours online

Table 3. users.csv (~35,000 rows)

Column	Type	Description
user_id	STRING	Primary key
signup_date	DATE	Account creation date
city	STRING	User's primary city
total_rides	INTEGER	Total lifetime rides taken
last_ride_date	DATE	Date of most recent completed ride
promo_rides	INTEGER	Number of rides where a promo was applied
wallet_balance	FLOAT	Current in-app wallet balance (USD)
churn_flag	BOOLEAN	True if no ride in the past 60 days

Table 4. support_tickets.csv (~22,000 rows)

Column	Type	Description
ticket_id	STRING	Primary key
ride_id	STRING	FK → rides.csv (blank if not ride-related)
user_id	STRING	FK → users.csv
driver_id	STRING	FK → drivers.csv (blank if unrelated to driver)
created_at	DATETIME	When the ticket was submitted
category	STRING	fare_dispute safety lost_item app_issue driver_behaviour
severity	STRING	low medium high critical

Column	Type	Description
resolved	BOOLEAN	Whether the ticket has been closed
resolution_time_hours	FLOAT	Hours to resolution (blank if unresolved)

Dashboard Requirements

You must build one dashboard in either of the two tools below. Define core business metrics with clarity, create intuitive data views, and translate them into actionable interpretations.

Looker Studio (Google Data Studio)	Tableau
- Free at lookerstudio.google.com - Share via view-only link - Use Google Sheets or CSV connector - Minimum 4 pages / report sections - Clear, presentable & easy to interpret visualization	- Tableau Public (free) accepted - Publish to Tableau Public and submit URL - Use .hyper or direct CSV connection - Minimum 4 dashboard sheets - Clear, presentable & easy to interpret visualization

Problem Statement & Recommendations

In a separate pdf document (or as annotated pages in your dashboard), identify at least **three to five business problems** you have discovered in the data. For each problem, you must provide:

Element	What We Expect
Problem statement	One clear sentence/paragraph describing what is wrong and where
Evidence	The specific metric, chart, or pattern that reveals the problem
Root cause hypothesis	Your interpretation of why this is happening
Recommended action	A concrete, implementable action with supporting data
Success metric	How you would measure whether the fix worked

Step by Step Guidelines

1	Download and open all four CSV files. Inspect the schema, column types, and value ranges.
2	Understand the business Context
3	Perform exploratory analysis first. We recommend using Python, SQL, or even Excel pivot tables before going into Tableau or Looker Studio. This will help you understand the shape of the data and form hypotheses.
4	Build your Looker Studio/tableau dashboard. Connect your CSV files via Google Sheets or direct upload.
5	Write your problem statement. Identify core problems, each with evidence, root cause, recommended action, and a success metric.
6	Submission: Email both dashboard URLs and your written problem statement & Solution before deadline

Submission Checklist

Use this before submitting to ensure you have not missed anything:

☐	Looker Studio/Tableau Public dashboard URL is publicly accessible (test in an incognito window), python_script/ sql queries for data extraction & preprocessing
☐	Dashboards contains Meaningful KPI's
☐	Proper breakdown is present and filterable in the dashboard
☐	Written problem statement covers at least 3-5 problems
☐	Each problem includes: evidence, root cause, recommended action, success metric
☐	All submission links and documents sent before the deadline. (Tip: Share the dashboard link in the problem statement document)
☐	Submission File_name example: {name_BI Analyst}

Presentation (Interview Round)

If you are selected for an interview, you will be asked to present your dashboards to a mock stakeholder panel for **10-15 minutes**.

You should be prepared to:

- Lead with the most critical problems and their business impact
- Walk through your dashboards live-assume the panel will ask you to navigate to specific charts
- Defend your methodology well- how did you choose which metrics to show?
- Answer questions such as:
 - How confident are you in this data? What would make you more confident?
 - If you had a team of two and one week, what would you prioritise?
 - How would you track whether your recommendations actually worked?

What We are looking for

This is not a test of how many charts you can make. It is a test of whether you can **think like a data analyst**.

We are specifically evaluating:

- Whether you can navigate a realistic, messy dataset and derive meaningful insights without being told what to look for
- Whether your dashboards communicate clearly to a non-technical audience
- Whether you can identify root causes, not just symptoms, and connect them to actionable business decisions
- Whether you can defend your choices under questioning